

Section Title(S): THE EXPRESSION OF ANGER

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Shivering in anger, which begins half in play among boys when there are no moran around, appears to develop into a conditioned response among moran, and then to subside in elderhood. The normal explanation offered by the Matapato for a bout of shaking is that it is triggered off by large quantities of beef and certain roots that moran mix with their soups. These spiced soups are described as the 'beer of young people' that can excite their emotions, sometimes making them happy, and at other times unpredictably irritable. The roots then 'blacken their hearts' so that they become angry and shake, and 'cry with tears like a child'. Analysis of some of these roots, however, has indicated no chemical properties that might induce shivering or shaking.² The explanation, [122](#) therefore, appears to lie in the conditioning of the moran and the beliefs that surround the Maasai concept of anger.

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It is clear from such remarks that the Matapato also accept that tears may express pain and distress as well as anger, as when a bride approaches her husband's village (p. 31). However, only tears of anger and not anguish are appropriate for men and especially for moran.

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